الرواد الرقميون
DiGiLiANS

وزارة الاتصالات وتكنولوجيا المعلومات

Digilians

Leadership Skills

Module One

LEADERSHIP SKILLS

Participant's Manual

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Program Overview

The Modern Leader Course is designed to provide participants with the essential knowledge, skills, and tools required to be able to lead effectively in the modern world.

The program focuses on raising self-awareness, strategic thinking and developing interpersonal skills needed for leaders to build high performing teams, drive performance, and foster a positive work environment.

The course is highly interactive, and it combines theoretical knowledge with practical strategies to ensure hands-on practical application.

Learning Objectives:

By the end of the course, participants will be able to:

- Define modern leadership
- Demonstrate leadership without authority
- Differentiate between leadership and management
- Demonstrate required leadership styles
- Apply strategic thinking for leaders
- Demonstrate key interpersonal skills for leaders such as EQ & building teams
- Practice leadership skills for entrepreneurs
- Prepare a personal leadership development plan

Program Modules:

Module 1: Foundation of Leadership

Module 2: Leadership Styles

Module 3: Strategic Leadership

Module 4: Interpersonal Skills of Leaders

Module 1: Foundation of Leadership

Definition of Leadership:

- "Leadership is the ability to influence, inspire, and guide others toward achieving a common goal."
- "Unlike authority, leadership is not always tied to formal power. True leaders inspire, motivate, and build trust."

Leadership involves:

- Vision, influence, and inspiration.
- It is not about controlling people, but about empowering them.
- Leadership occurs at all levels—you don't need a title to be a leader.

Modern Leadership

- Modern leadership focuses on fostering agility, innovation, inclusivity, and ethical decision-making to drive success in a fast-changing world.
- It involves a dynamic, human-centered approach that empowers teams through empathy, collaboration, and a focus on shared purpose and continuous growth, moving beyond traditional top-down management to a more networked and adaptive style.

Self-leadership

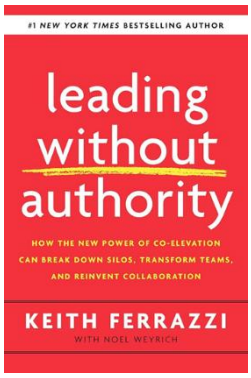
Self-leadership is the practice of *influencing yourself* to achieve goals, using strategies like goal-setting, self-talk, and self-discipline to manage your thoughts, feelings, and actions for better performance, effectiveness, and personal growth, forming the basis for leading others.

Leadership Versus Management

Leadership	Management
Focuses on vision	Focuses on execution
Inspires people	Coordinates people
Drives change and innovation	Maintains stability and control
Works through influence	Works through authority
Leads people	Manages work

Leading Without Authority

What Does "Leading Without Authority" Mean?



- It means influencing others and driving positive change even when you don't have a formal title like "manager" or "team lead." It's about impact, not hierarchy.

Instead of relying on position power, you rely on:

- Relationships
- Credibility
- Communication
- Initiative

Why It Matters for New Graduates?

As a new graduate, you're unlikely to have direct reports or decision-making power — but you can still lead by:

- Bringing fresh ideas
- Encouraging collaboration
- Taking ownership of tasks
- Being a source of positivity and initiative
- This kind of influence often gets noticed — and opens doors for formal leadership later.

How to Lead Without Authority?

1. Build Trust & Relationships

- Get to know your colleagues across departments.
- Be reliable: follow through on your commitments.
- Support others — be helpful without expecting anything in return.
- *"People will follow you if they trust you — not because they have to, but because they want to."*

2. Communicate Clearly and Confidently

- Ask thoughtful questions.
- Share ideas respectfully.
- Listen actively to others' perspectives.
- Even if you're junior, **your voice can influence** decisions when it's clear, respectful, and rooted in good intent.

3. Take Initiative

- Volunteer for new projects.
- Spot problems and propose solutions.
- Don't wait to be told what to do — start where you are.
- This shows leadership and a proactive mindset.

4. Become a Subject Matter Resource

- Build expertise in something valuable to your team.
- Share what you learn — become a go-to person in that area.
- Even if you're new, **you can lead through knowledge.**

5. Model a Growth Mindset

- Embrace challenges as learning opportunities.
- Be open to feedback — and act on it.
- Celebrate others' wins and lift people up.
- People naturally follow those who are **resilient, curious, and optimistic**.

Growth Mindset vs. Fixed Mindset in Leadership

Growth Mindset vs. Fixed Mindset in Leadership

	Growth Mindset	Fixed Mindset
Definition	Belief that abilities and intelligence can be developed through effort, learning, and feedback.	Belief that abilities and intelligence are static—you either have it or you don't.
View of Challenges	Embraces challenges as opportunities to grow	Avoids challenges out of fear of failure
Response to Failure	Learns from failure and tries again	Sees failure as proof of inadequacy
Effort	Believes effort leads to mastery	Believes effort is pointless if you're "not talented"
Feedback	Seeks and uses feedback to improve	Ignores or gets defensive about feedback

Why Growth Mindset Matters in Leadership

Area	Growth Mindset Leader
Team Development	Coaches and mentors others; believes people can grow into roles.
Change Management	Views change as a learning curve, not a threat.
Innovation	Encourages experimentation, tolerates smart failure.
Resilience	Bounces back from setbacks and motivates others to do the same.

Growth Mindset Leadership Example

Leader: Ronaldo Mouchawar (Co-founder of Souq.com)

Situation: When launching Souq.com in the early 2000s, Mouchawar and his team faced poor logistics, limited online payment options, and low customer trust.

Mindset in Action: Instead of giving up, he adapted to the region's limitations, introduced cash-on-delivery, and continuously learned from market behavior — eventually scaling the company and selling to Amazon.

Lesson: Leaders with a growth mindset innovate, persist, and turn problems into learning opportunities.

Fixed Mindset Leadership Example

Leader: A team manager who avoids delegating complex tasks because they believe only they can do them “right.”

Behavior: When a junior employee makes a mistake, the leader sees it as proof that the employee isn’t “cut out for leadership” and stops giving them opportunities.

Impact: The team stops taking initiative, morale drops, and innovation slows.

Lesson: Fixed mindset leaders **limit growth**, both their own and their team's, by avoiding risk and failing to invest in potential.

Growth Mindset Behaviors of Leaders

1. **Embrace Challenges:** Actively seek out difficult tasks and view them as opportunities to learn, not threats.
2. **Persist Through Setbacks:** Show grit and determination, bouncing back from failure by increasing effort and adapting strategies.
3. **Learn from Criticism:** See feedback and constructive criticism as valuable tools for improvement, asking clarifying questions to understand and apply it.
4. **Value Effort:** Understand that hard work and practice are essential for developing skills and achieving mastery.
5. **Adopt the "Not Yet" Mindset:** Use "I can't do this *yet*" to acknowledge current limitations while focusing on future growth.
6. **Seek Inspiration:** Find motivation in the success of others rather than feeling threatened by it.
7. **Focus on Process:** Prioritize learning and development over proving innate talent or intelligence.
8. **Ask Questions:** Admit when you don't know something and ask for help as a strength.

Personal Traits of Leaders

Common Traits:

1. Self Awareness
2. Integrity
3. Accountability
3. Courage
4. Assertiveness
5. Positive outlook & Passion
6. Resilience
7. Commitment to continuous learning
8. Decisiveness

Top Ten Skills for 2030

The World Economic Forum's (WEF) Future of Jobs Report 2025 identifies key skills for 2030, blending tech fluency (AI & Big Data, Cybersecurity, Tech Literacy) with crucial human-centric abilities (Creative Thinking, Resilience, Lifelong Learning, Leadership, Analytical Thinking, Talent Management, Environmental Stewardship). The report emphasizes that while technology skills are in high demand, uniquely human skills that AI can't replicate, combined with strong digital literacy, will be most valuable for navigating a rapidly changing job market, with analytical thinking and creativity topping the list.

Key Skills of Successful Leaders

- Communication – Clear, honest, and motivating messaging.
- Decision-Making – Making timely, informed, and ethical choices.
- Emotional Intelligence (EI) – Managing your emotions and understanding others'.
- Conflict Resolution – Handling disputes in a healthy and productive way.
- Adaptability – Adjusting to change and guiding others through it.
- Team Building – Creating a positive, collaborative team culture.
- Strategic Thinking – Seeing the big picture and aligning actions with goals.

Communication – Clear, Honest, and Motivating Messaging

- **Clarity**: Leaders must convey messages in a way that is easy to understand, avoiding jargon and ambiguity.
- **Honesty**: Transparency builds trust. A good leader communicates openly, even when delivering difficult news.
- **Motivation**: Communication should inspire action and align the team with a shared vision or goal.
- **Active Listening**: Great communicators also listen well, encouraging feedback and ensuring others feel heard.

Conflict Resolution – Handling Disputes in a Healthy and Productive Way

- **Addressing Issues Early:** Avoiding escalation by intervening when conflict arises.
- **Mediation Skills:** Helping conflicting parties find common ground and mutual solutions.
- **Maintaining Respect:** Encouraging respectful dialogue and avoiding blame.
- **Solution-Oriented:** Focused on outcomes that benefit the team and align with organizational goals.

Decision-Making – Timely, Informed, and Ethical Choices

- **Timely**: Effective leaders don't procrastinate. They know when enough information has been gathered to act.
- **Informed**: Decisions are based on data, stakeholder input, and sound judgment.
- **Ethical**: Integrity is central. Ethical leaders consider the long-term consequences and fairness of their decisions.
- **Accountable**: They stand by their decisions and learn from outcomes, both good and bad.

Emotional Intelligence (EI) – Managing Your Emotions and Understanding Others'

- **Self-Awareness:** Recognizing your own emotional triggers and biases.
- **Self-Regulation:** Staying calm and composed, especially under stress.
- **Empathy:** Understanding and being sensitive to the feelings and perspectives of others.
- **Social Skills:** Building rapport, resolving conflict, and fostering cooperation.

Adaptability – Adjusting to Change and Guiding Others Through It

- **Flexibility:** Willingness to change strategies or approaches when conditions shift.
- **Resilience:** Bouncing back from setbacks and maintaining a positive outlook.
- **Change Leadership:** Helping others embrace change by clearly communicating the "why" and supporting them through transitions.
- **Continuous Learning:** Staying curious and open to new ideas, tools, and feedback.

Team Building – Creating a Positive, Collaborative Team Culture

- **Trust Building**: Creating an environment where team members feel safe and supported.
- **Empowerment**: Delegating effectively and encouraging autonomy.
- **Inclusivity**: Valuing diversity and ensuring everyone feels included.
- **Recognition**: Celebrating wins and recognizing individual and group contributions.

Strategic Thinking – Seeing the Big Picture and Aligning Actions with Goals

- **Vision-Oriented**: Keeping the long-term vision in mind when making decisions.
- **Prioritization**: Identifying which actions will have the greatest impact.
- **Systems Thinking**: Understanding how various elements of the organization interact.
- **Innovation**: Looking for opportunities to improve and stay ahead of the curve.

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LEADERSHIP SKILLS